Imran Sheikh

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Professional Summary

SOC Analyst L2 with over three years of experience investigating Splunk alerts and EDR detections for BFSI and retail clients. Experienced in ransomware, credential theft and phishing investigations, with solid use of MITRE ATT&CK to document findings. Handles escalations from L1 and writes incident reports for client security teams.

Technical Skills

Incident Investigation: Alert validation, scoping, timeline reconstruction, containment recommendations, incident reports

SIEM: Splunk Enterprise Security (correlation searches, notable events), SPL, dashboards

EDR: CrowdStrike Falcon (detections, host containment, RTR), process tree analysis

Threat Intelligence: IOC enrichment with VirusTotal, AlienVault OTX and MISP lookups, MITRE ATT&CK mapping

Log Analysis: Windows Event Logs, Sysmon, proxy, DNS and firewall logs

Process: Playbook authoring, L1 mentoring, shift handover, client communications

Work Experience

SOC Analyst L2 - Konkan Cyber Defence Services Pvt Ltd

Mumbai, Maharashtra | *Jul 2024 - Present*

- Investigate escalated incidents from Splunk ES and CrowdStrike for six clients; average time to containment recommendation 42 minutes for high-severity cases.
- Led the analysis of a ransomware precursor incident in a retail client: traced suspicious PowerShell and credential dumping to an unpatched VPN host, isolated three endpoints and delivered an incident report within 24 hours.
- Tuned 12 Splunk correlation searches (threshold and allow-list changes), reducing false positives by 27%.
- Authored five playbooks for phishing, malware, brute force, impossible travel and suspicious PowerShell.
- Coach three L1 analysts on triage quality and ATT&CK mapping.

SOC Analyst L1 - Konkan Cyber Defence Services Pvt Ltd

Mumbai, Maharashtra | *Jul 2023 - Jun 2024*

- Triaged about 40 alerts per shift in Splunk, escalating validated incidents with evidence and IOC lists.
- Performed phishing and malware triage using sandbox reports and threat intelligence lookups.
- Maintained shift logs and handover notes with a 100% completeness rating in quarterly audits.

Projects

Detection Tuning for Brute-force Alerts

- Problem: Authentication alerts created heavy noise from service accounts and VPN gateways.
- Approach: Profiled normal behaviour by account type, added lookups for known-good sources and moved from fixed thresholds to per-account baselines.
- Technologies: Splunk SPL, Lookups
- Results: Brute-force alert volume dropped 38% with no missed true positives in back-testing.

ATT&CK Coverage Mapping

- Problem: The team could not see which techniques its detections covered.
- Approach: Mapped 90 existing correlation searches to ATT&CK techniques and visualised gaps in a matrix.
- Technologies: MITRE ATT&CK Navigator, Excel
- Results: Identified six high-priority gaps that were added to the detection backlog.

Education

B.E., Information Technology, Konkan School of Engineering, Mumbai (2019 - 2023) - CGPA 7.8 / 10

Certifications

- CompTIA Security+ (2023)

- Splunk Core Certified Power User (2024)
- Blue Team Level 1 (BTL1) (2024)

Achievements

- Promoted from L1 to L2 in 12 months.
- Recognised by a client for rapid containment during a credential theft incident.